

QIP-001 – SEMM91 Single-Player Expansion

- **Title:** SEMM91 – Scandinavian Extreme Metal Manager '91
 - **Category:** Future Version / Expansion
 - **Question / Idea:**
What is the full feature set, structure, and design of SEMM91 as the expanded single-player version of Demo(n)Tapes?
 - **Current Thought:**
SEMM91 is envisioned as a single-player campaign where the player manages a band with additional systems: record labels, live gigs/tours, illegal notoriety operations, and more detailed career progression.
 - **Priority:** Low (long-term vision)
 - **Blocking:** No (does not affect current multiplayer prototype)
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QIP-002 – Android / Smart Device Port

- **Title:** Mobile / Android Version
- **Category:** Platform & Port Concepts
- **Question / Idea:**
How should Demo(n)Tapes be adapted into a mobile/smart device game, given the social/audio-heavy Keeper mechanics?
- **Current Thought:**
 - Core interaction on mobile is “dragging small boxes into larger boxes and pressing a button.”
 - Keeper gameplay and audio-based social interaction do not translate well to casual mobile play.
 - A mobile variant might:
 - Drop the Keeper role and emigrating host gameplay.
 - Focus on tape-exchange between nearby players (proximity-based transfers).
 - Use collectibles/trophies visualized as a virtual “battle vest”.
- **Priority:** Low
- **Blocking:** No

QIP-003 – Custom Band Logos (Upload & In-Game Editor)

- **Title:** Player-Created Logos
 - **Category:** Customization Features
 - **Question / Idea:**
Should players be able to provide custom band logos, and if so, how (file upload vs. in-game tool)?
 - **Current Thought:**
 - Default logo for Not_Saved.SNO is predefined.
 - Future features might include:
 - Uploading small bitmap images as logos.
 - Hosting a simple in-game logo drawing/painting tool.
 - **Priority:** Medium
 - **Blocking:** No (cosmetic / QoL)
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QIP-004 – Geo-Based Country of Origin

- **Title:** Automatic Country of Origin from Player Location
 - **Category:** UX / Flavour Feature
 - **Question / Idea:**
Should the band's country-of-origin suffix (e.g. ".SNO") be determined from the player's real-world location instead of a dropdown?
 - **Current Thought:**
 - Currently designed as a dropdown menu choice.
 - Future online version might read approximate user location (within privacy constraints) to auto-set origin.
 - **Priority:** Low
 - **Blocking:** No
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QIP-005 – Extended Genre Systems (Death / Doom / Hybrids)

- **Title:** De-Sacralising & Sacralising Tag-Pairs

- **Category:** Mechanics – Future Extension
 - **Question / Idea:**
How should de-sacralising (tag + NULL-tag) and sacralising (double-tag) systems be fully defined for death metal and doom metal, and how do blackened hybrid genres work mechanically?
 - **Current Thought:**
 - Black metal uses **re-sacralising tag-pairs** (tag + anti-tag) as core TRUE-defining mechanic.
 - Death metal and doom metal are hinted to use:
 - De-sacralising tag-pair (tag vs NULL-tag).
 - Sacralising tag-pair (tag + tag).
 - Blackened death / blackened doom would combine multiple tag-pair types and yield better score per track.
 - Marked as “beyond the scope of this project for the time being”.
 - **Priority:** Medium (interesting design space)
 - **Blocking:** No (current prototype only needs black metal logic)
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QIP-006 – Band and Collective Systems (Detail Level)

- **Title:** Detailed Band & Collective Systems
- **Category:** Systems Definition
- **Question / Idea:**
What additional mechanics, stats, and UI are needed for band-level and other collective-level systems beyond the basic “collective chooses an action” model?
- **Current Thought:**
 - Section 4.8 (“Band and Collective Systems”) is a placeholder.
 - Possible future elements:
 - Collective-level resources (cash, reputation, shared tags/aspects).
 - Internal band tensions, breakups, side projects.
 - Extended interactions between multiple collectives (alliances, rivalries).
- **Priority:** Medium

- **Blocking:** No (core loop can function with minimal band-level detail)
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QIP-007 – Multiplayer Mode Details

- **Title:** Multiplayer Model & Infrastructure
 - **Category:** Networking / Mode Design
 - **Question / Idea:**
How exactly does online multiplayer function (matchmaking, lobbies, game length, reconnection, etc.) for Demo(n)Tapes?
 - **Current Thought:**
 - Section 4.9 (“Multiplayer Mode”) is currently only a heading.
 - Open questions:
 - Number of players per session.
 - Host/authority model (dedicated server vs. host player).
 - How Keepers are handled across disconnects/joins.
 - Persistence (single long campaign vs. shorter matches).
 - **Priority:** High (for a fully playable online release)
 - **Blocking:** Potentially blocking for shipping a real online prototype, but not for paper/boardgame-style prototype or local testing.
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QIP-008 – Business Model, DLC, and Monetization

- **Title:** Business / Monetization Strategy
- **Category:** Business Definitions
- **Question / Idea:**
What is the intended business model for Demo(n)Tapes and potential later versions (SEMM91, expansions, DLC, in-app purchases)?
- **Current Thought:**
 - Current stance: project is an art piece and not reliant on commercial success.
 - Possible future approaches:
 - Free base game with cosmetic DLC or expansions.

- Paid SEMM91 as a full product, with Demo(n)Tapes remaining a demo/teaser.
 - No monetization at all, purely portfolio/art.
 - **Priority:** Low for current course project
 - **Blocking:** No
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QIP-009 – Concept Art, Story & World Progression Detail

- **Title:** Detailed Story, Progression & Concept Art
 - **Category:** Narrative & Visuals
 - **Question / Idea:**
How much detailed story, world progression (World 1, World 2, etc.), and concept art is needed beyond high-level summaries?
 - **Current Thought:**
 - Sections 5, 7.1, 7.2, 7.9 are mainly placeholders.
 - For the introduction course, brief summaries are sufficient; full campaign/story arcs, multi-world structures and a full concept art book are not required.
 - There should be no detailed story beyond the background of the scene before turn 1. This background could be somewhat RNG/Procedural Gen, so “TRUE” could have different starting positions.
 - **Priority:** Medium (strong thematic support, but non-essential)
 - **Blocking:** No
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QIP – 010 – Conceptualizing the main screen

- **Title:** The main window while in play (accessible for all players)
- **Category:** UI & Central Game Play Mechanics
- **Question / Idea:**
What does the actual game screen look like at the beginning of the turn? How does it serve The Keeper? The Player? The Outcast?
- **Current Thought:**
 - The screen must depict a gaming board of some sort. The most important thing it does is establishing “TRUE” to the players – to show them what tags are in play and in what position.

- Only the Keeper can directly interact with the pieces on the board, within the confines of their Pull trait. The players should see in real time these interactions.
 - There should also be an individual area on the main screen per player, which could host mail, for example.
 - The main screen hosts for both players and keepers and reflect the societal influence of the scene. As the game progresses, establishments are influenced by game events.
 - **Priority:** High (this is a very important screen.)
 - **Blocking:** Yes.
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QIP – 011 – Conceptualizing the Gestation Screen

- **Title:** The Gestation Screen (accessible for all players)
 - **Category:** UI & Central Game Play Mechanics
 - **Question / Idea:**
What does the gestation game screen look like? How does it make “the outside world” accessible to players?
 - **Current Thought:**
 - The outside world is shared by all the players. Could be a spread sheet containing Game Entity Structures for now.
 - **Priority:** High (this is a very important screen.)
 - **Blocking:** Yes.
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QIP – 012 – Conceptualizing the Rehearsal Screen

- **Title:** The Rehearsal Screen (accessible for all non-Keeper players)
- **Category:** UI & Central Game Play Mechanics
- **Question / Idea:**
What does the rehearsal space look like?
- **Current Thought:**
 - Could be the same all, but later modifiable and reflective of the band members.
- **Priority:** High (this is a very important screen.)
- **Blocking:** Yes.

QIP – 013 – Conceptualizing the Promotion Screen

- **Title:** The Promotion Screen (accessible for all players)
- **Category:** UI & Central Game Play Mechanics
- **Question / Idea:**
What is this even?
- **Current Thought:**
 - I have given these zero thoughts.
- **Priority:** High (this is a very important screen.)
- **Blocking:** Yes.

QIP – 014 – Conceptualizing the Keeper Ledger/Band Roster

- **Title:** A folding ledger at the left side of the main screen.
- **Category:** UI & Central Game Play Mechanics
- **Question / Idea:**
A folding ledger provides access to the free player actions, and keeper actions.
- **Current Thought:**
 - For keepers, the keeper actions are located on this ledger.
 - For other players, direct access to band members and other characters are here. All the free actions are executed here.
- **Priority:** High (this is a very important screen.)
- **Blocking:** Yes.

QIP – 015 – A downtime Fidget

- **Title:** Whenever a player is waiting for others to finish their turns, there is a fidget spinner type minigame available that has some minimal influence on gameplay but gets taken away at the beginning of the next turn.
- **Category:** UI & Central Game Play Mechanics

- **Question / Idea:**
Scribbling of Cassette Art and vandalizing the Keeper's table
 - **Current Thought:**
 - For keepers, the player can doodle things on the desk and they stick throughout the game.
 - For other players, a scrap paper is available to draw demo tape art etc.
 - **Priority:** Low.
 - **Blocking:** No.
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QIP – 016 – The Scene Map (Semantic Gravity Field)

- **Title:** Scene Map – Semantic Gravity & Authenticity Field
- **Category:** Core System / UI & Cultural Simulation
- **Question / Idea:**
What is the exact structure, visualization, and mechanical role of the Scene Map as a representation of “TRUE”, gravity, and subcultural drift within Demo(n)Tapes?
- **Current Thought:**
The Scene Map is not a geographic or chronological map, but a **semantic field** representing the ideological state of the scene.

Key conceptual elements:

- Demo tapes exist as nodes within an abstract ideological space.
- Each demo exerts **gravity**, derived from TRUE tag-pairs, repetition, and conveyance.
- Gravity visually deforms the scene into wells or depressions, inspired by general relativity metaphors.
- “TRUE” is not binary but represented as a **contour threshold**: material within sufficient gravitational depth is considered TRUE. (Wrong. An object that orbits a true tag is true.)
- The scene's thematic centre drifts over time as gravity accumulates from influential demos.
- Repeated, proselytizing TRUE tag-pairs may form **secondary gravity basins**, representing subscenes. A note on proselytizing: If a proselytizing album has a TRUE tag that is pure from proselytizing, it does not splinter from the scene but remains encapsulated within it. If it's at a distant orbit, it can be pressurised to splinter away.

- Subscenes may remain attached via ridges (shared legitimacy) or fully splinter into separate centres. (The orbit signifies allegiance).
- Keeper actions may temporarily distort gravity, elevate or suppress demos, or redefine surface-level true, but cannot permanently erase TRUE gravity without sustained counteraction, unless a concentrated effort permanently forces the demo out of orbit, which either causes a splinter in the scene, or causes the demo to fade to obscurity.

Open questions include:

- How much of the gravity calculation is visible vs. implied? A: The Keeper should always be the first to learn of the changes in the scene as they happen. Others should learn of the changes with delay, either by tape trading or “hearing” about new demos via other means (a hype factor?).
- Whether the Scene Map is navigable or purely observational. A: Shouldn’t be navigable. Instead, it should always scale out to fit the entire scene (or the local player’s understanding of it).
- How historical demos decay or remain as “fossilized” gravity. A: Demos should not decay on the map, since they are abstracted into cultural entities.
- How anti-tags and ideological opposition are visualized (repulsion, flattening, noise). A: There should exist certain “CPU” tags that represent outside forces. Like for example, a successfully promoted black metal for masses should orbit something else than a true tag. A dollar sign perhaps. Or another demo could orbit arts as an institution.

Design Intent:

The Scene Map functions as the game’s **primary authenticity instrument**, allowing players to *read* legitimacy, drift, and conflict without explicit numerical exposition. It externalizes countercultural dynamics—gatekeeping, canon formation, and schism—into a shared, observable field.

- **Priority:** High
- **Blocking:** Yes
(The Scene Map is foundational to understanding TRUE, Keeper power, subscenes, and long-term trajectory. UI and several mechanics cannot be finalized without it.)